Spring 2025 Newsletter

Please share this newsletter with your club members

RWH 2024 Annual General Meeting



Our Members and Guests



Isabelle Martinez Hayer
Incoming DG 5050



Sean Hogan PDG Dean Rohrs



Michael and
Jane Woolnough



Flora and
Bernie Pregler



Jim McGrandles



Janice Froese

Ralphie Award Recipients

Ralph Towsley was the binding person of the group of 3 who were instrumental in putting into motion the creation of ROTARY WORLD HELP NETWORK in 1997. The Ralphie Award was created in honour of him.

Member Clubs Present at the AGM

Burnaby	Burnaby Deer Lake
Cambie	Chilliwack
Coquitlam	Coquitlam Sunrise
Fraserview *	Langley
Langley Central	Langley Sunrise
New Westminster	Lions Gate N. Vancouver
North Delta	Pemberton *
PNW Passport	Port Coquitlam Centennial
Port Moody	Richmond
Richmond Sunrise	Richmond Noon
Semiahmoo	Steveston
Sechelt *	Tsawwassen
Surrey	Vancouver
Vancouver Arbutus	West Vancouver
Whistler *	White Rock

***Proxy**

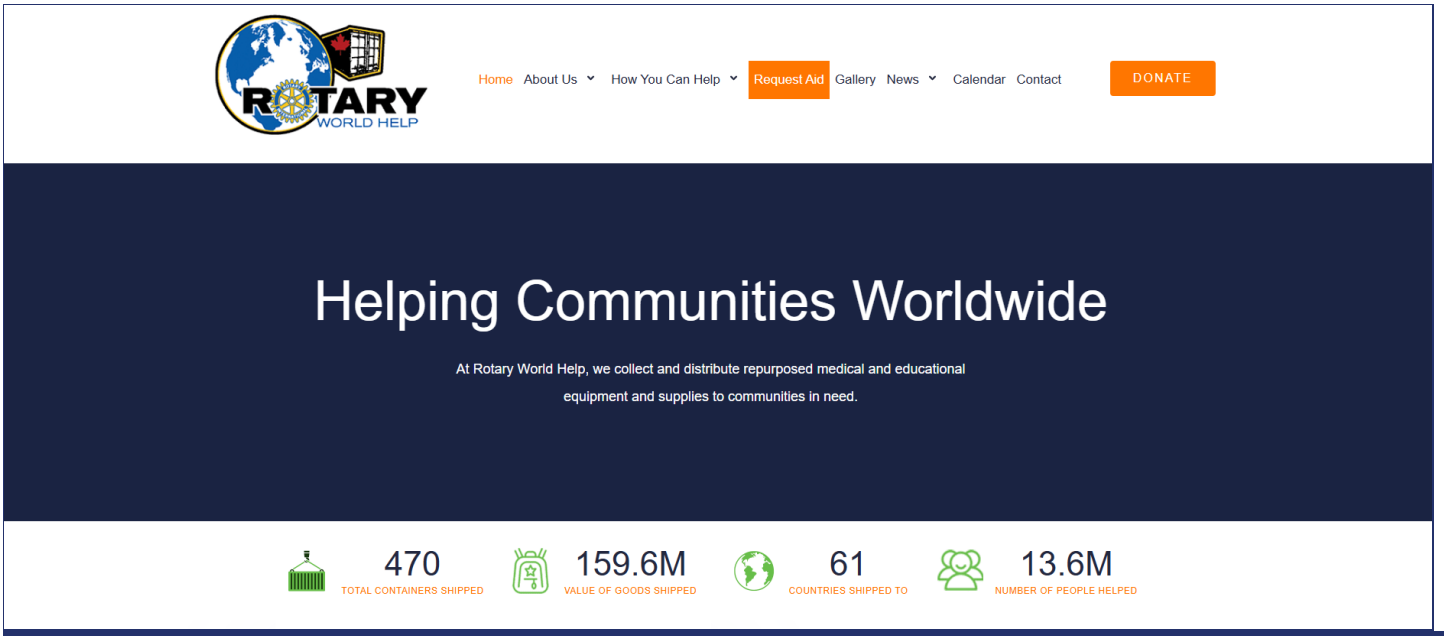
At the Rotary World Help AGM, Dr. Kathleen Ross—family physician and immediate past president of the Canadian Medical Association (CMA)—delivered a wide-ranging and passionate address on the state and future of Canadian healthcare. Drawing from over 30 years of frontline experience, she spoke about the unique privilege and challenges of working in family medicine and how that perspective shapes her advocacy at the national level.

Dr. Ross emphasized that Canada's healthcare system, guided by the Canada Health Act's principles, is struggling under increasing complexity, long wait times, clinician burnout, and a fragmented delivery model. While the COVID-19 pandemic amplified these issues, many were long-standing. A significant focus of her address was on the administrative burden facing physicians, with many spending 10+ hours weekly on tasks that could be automated or reassigned—an inefficiency equivalent to millions of lost patient visits annually.

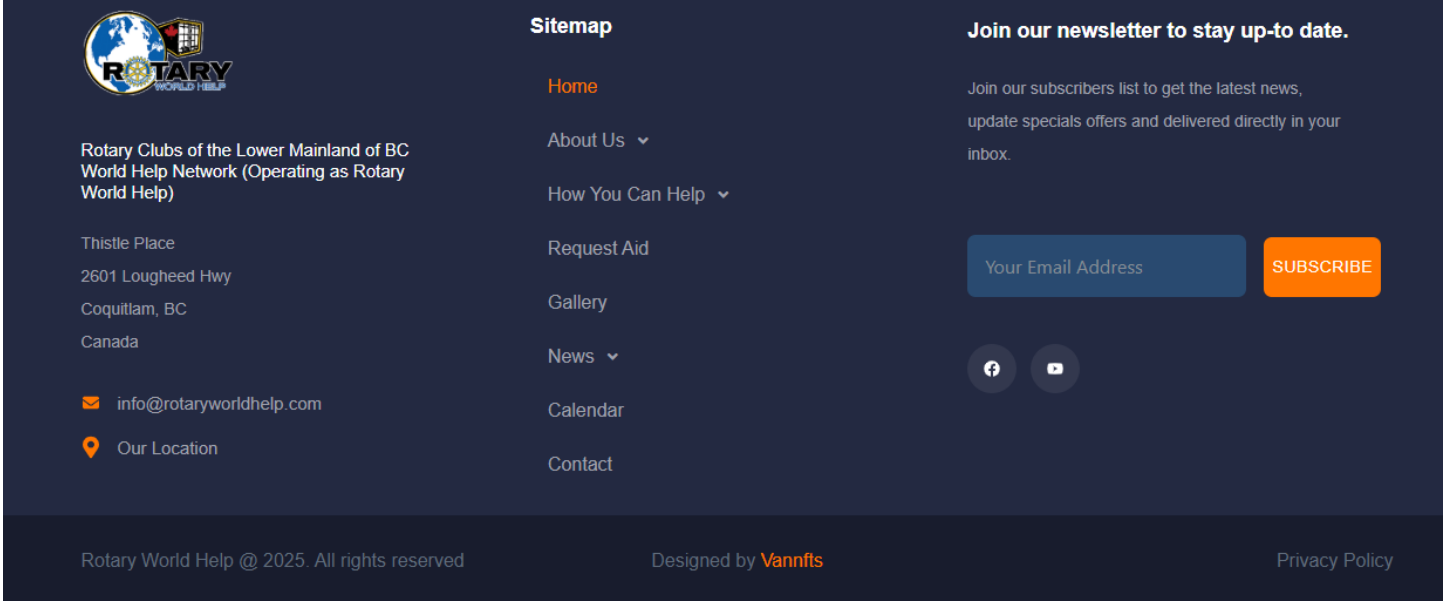
She advocated for system transformation through team-based, interdisciplinary care models, smarter use of digital health tools, and reducing reliance on outdated systems like fax machines. Dr. Ross highlighted the potential of AI and virtual care, but also called attention to the digital divide and the need for equitable access.

Touching on sensitive topics such as the public-private healthcare balance, she noted that Canadians strongly favor maintaining equity and improving the public system. She also underscored the CMA's ongoing commitment to Indigenous health, climate change advocacy, and addressing systemic inequities in healthcare.

Dr. Ross closed by envisioning a modernized, accessible, community-rooted health system powered by collaboration, clinician leadership, and digital innovation. She called on Rotarians—as community leaders—to support this vision and contribute to shaping a healthcare system that meets the needs of all Canadians with compassion, equity, and sustainability.



Announcing our New Website



Containers Loaded January to April 2025

Philippines sponsored by Rotary Club Richmond Sunrise January 11, 2025





Belize Sponsored by Port Moody Rotary Club February 8, 2025





Ukraine Sponsored by Vancouver Arbutus Rotary Club March 15, 2025





Ukraine Sponsored by Art & Glenna Gillan and the Rotary Club of Kelowna Capri April 12, 2025





Upcoming loadings May to June 2025

May 10 to Ethiopia

June 14 to Guatemala

Cheers,

Jerry P. Zdril

President and Shipping Manager

Rotary World Help